

Thread - 2025-01-13

<https://x.com/RiikonenMarko/status/1878700207644229845>

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Could these pass as the Parry spot crystals? I inspected this plate last night. It is in transmitted light, view is from straight above to the horizontally oriented ice plate surface.

My visual inspection of this plate halos yesterday morning after it had cooked overnight didn't catch any Parry spots. So I let it continue simmering and in the evening I saw a weakish Ujvarosi star appeared. Which would be in line with these crystals being uppermost, i.e. the latest growth layer on the plate (or when the plate is cooking lowermost, I turn it upside down for the inspection in microscope).

But the crystals look hollow, not much halo makers. Then again the Ujvarosi star was not strong. But most of all I don't see the 60 degree arrangement (or should it be said 120?) in their pointing directions. So I am not bought yet, the search is still on. Possibly these are just upright protruding crystals that had collapsed to the ground from shock of me breaking the plate in pieces for inspection under the microscope. Or swiping the plate accidentally with my glowed hand.

In the background for these columns is the base layer of the regimented plates, you can see their shapes vaguely at around .

I am still not sure what is the exact role of the base layer in making halos. They most probably make the white arcs and bright white spots, but how about the colored spots? As the base layer grows first this should allow to isolate its role. Take the plate for halo inspection early on before any protruding granular frost growth have appeared.

I didn't video any halos on this plate this time.

[video: 1878700207644229845-vAgnpasnV4ScOvl8.mp4]

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Here is an oblique view to the plate surface, I am holding with my other hand a piece of the ice plate at an angle to microscope objective. There are a couple of horizontally lying columns visible amongst the standing columns. I really think they have just fallen down, as are all the horizontal crystals in the video above. So the quest for photographing the Parry crystals is still very much ongoing endeavour.

[video: 1878703959029719339-7ikPd_6OUrWmnptd.mp4]
